



Delaware County Commissioners Meeting February 7th 2022

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=f1zNBt_u0zg
Publication Date	2022-02-07T16:18:32Z
Target Category	delaware_county

Notice: This report is provided by the [Muncie Policy Memo](#) as a public service. This summary is generated automatically using artificial intelligence from public video transcripts, both of which are prone to error. The report is intended to provide an overview of meeting business and an aid to accessing detailed information from the video recording. When accuracy is critical, please refer to the official video recording or approved minutes.

Delaware County Commissioners Meeting Summary

Meeting Date: February 7, 2022

1. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The meeting was called to order at [00:00:16](#) by the presiding officer, opening with the Pledge of Allegiance.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Mr. King, Mr. Henry, Mr. Riggin (noted in transcript as Reagan/Riggin), and Mr. Barrett.
 - **Presiding Officer:** Noted as leading the roll call and proceedings.

2. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance [00:00:32](#).
- **Approval of Minutes:** The minutes of the January 24th meeting were approved by roll call vote [00:02:00](#).

3. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:01:05 Board Appointment: Yorktown Library**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board Commissioners / Presiding Officer
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Kimberly Pike volunteered to serve on the Yorktown Library board.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote **00:01:47**.
- **00:02:09 Consulting Agreement: Dr. Lynn Witte**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Presiding Officer / John (Attorney) / Dr. Lynn Witte
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Dr. Lynn Witte, a retired pulmonary critical care physician and Ball State faculty member, has been volunteering extensive time in Delaware County and Muncie addressing mental health and addiction fields. The agreement establishes her as a paid consultant (covering approved expenses only, with no charge for her time) to assist with upcoming American Rescue Plan (ARP) factors and related initiatives.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote **00:04:11**.
- **00:04:18 Contract Addendum: Ritter Strategic Services**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Fred / John (Attorney)
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Due to a recent retirement, an addendum to the existing consulting contract with Ritter Strategic Services is required to finish the ongoing Computer-Aided Dispatch (CAD) build.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote **00:05:05**.
- **00:05:12 Project Amendment: Lochmueller Group (Inventory / Bridges & Culverts)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Marta Moody / Highway Department
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Amendment to an existing 4-year project for bridge and large culvert inspections (spans over 20 feet and inventory structures). The \$62,000 amendment is 80% reimbursable and funded through Marta's planning document.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote **00:06:13**.
- **00:06:19 Extension of Annual Material Bids: Highway Department**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Angie (Highway Department) / John (Attorney)
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Annual material bids were due Friday at noon, but the building was closed. Following the attorney's suggestion, the board moved to officially extend the bid acceptance deadline to noon today, with bids to be opened at the next meeting on February 22nd.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to extend time period to accept bids until noon today approved by roll call vote **00:07:53**.
- **00:08:04 Contract Supplement No. 4: Bridge 161 (Liberty Township)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Marta Moody
 - **Deliberation Summary:** A \$0 contract supplement for mitigation monitoring for the next three years regarding the newly replaced Bridge 161 (located west of

Wapahoney School between 167 South and 172 South in Liberty Township).

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote [00:08:29](#).
- [00:09:12](#) **Legal Services Agreement: Delaware County Election Board**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Spangler (covered by County Attorney)
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The Election Board retained Donald McClelland to represent them, utilizing Election Board funds.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote [00:09:47](#).
- [00:09:55](#) **Grant Application: Ball Brothers Foundation / Sheriff's Department**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Chief Deputy Jeff Stanley
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Application for a \$25,000 grant from the Ball Brothers Foundation to purchase equipment for cybersecurity crime mitigation, coordinated alongside Ball State and Muncie Police. Note: A corresponding fund-creation ordinance follows.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote [00:10:30](#).
- [00:10:55](#) **Informational Update: Muncie Land Bank**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jim Lowe (Ball State AVP / Land Bank Board), John West (Land Bank President), Megan Jennings (Executive Director)
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Provided an operational and strategic update on the Muncie Land Bank (formed in 2017, first auction March 2021). The Land Bank targets vacant/abandoned properties (noting 13% countywide vacancy, 16% in Muncie), clears titles, eliminates liabilities, and auctions properties to vetted buyers. They requested a streamlined communication process to request 10 to 20 county-held tax sale properties annually. Commissioners expressed general support subject to progress reporting and ensuring properties do not sit idle.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational presentation; no formal board vote required at this stage.
- [00:20:14](#) **Ordinance 2022-001: Health Department Rapid Response Grant Fund**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Health Department / County Attorney
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Establishes a new fund to receive a rapid response grant from the State Department of Health.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Introduced, rules suspended, and adopted via separate roll call votes, passing unanimously.
- [00:27:22](#) **Ordinance 2022-002: Court System Self-Help Center & Video Project**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Emily Anderson (Court Administrator)
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Funds a volunteer attorney two afternoons a week for the self-help center and pays an intern to convert in-person pro se/self-represented litigant classes into interactive online certification videos for the court website.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Introduced, rules suspended, and adopted via separate roll call votes, passing unanimously.
- [00:24:08](#) **Administrative Item: Justice Center Document Shredding Services**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Steven McCoffey / Emily

- **Deliberation Summary:** Following the discontinuation of shredding services by Rock Ten, alternative commercial shredding quotes were reviewed for Justice Center departments (Clerk, Courts, Probation). Five 96-gallon bins will cost \$109/month total (~\$36/month per department), shared among participating offices, with a 60-day cancellation policy. Commissioners advised surveying additional county buildings (EMS, Sheriff, Extension) before finalizing.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational review/direction given to survey other departments.
 - **00:29:40 Payment of Claims**
 - **Regular Claims:** \$2,488,653.93. Approved by roll call vote **00:29:57**.
 - **ARP Claims:** \$124,837.22 (included within claims review). Approved by roll call vote **00:30:29**.
-

4. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **00:30:51 Ryan Richards (Gaston):** Addressed the board regarding solar energy and agricultural land use. He cited an emerging industrial trend exploring 100% ethanol-fueled truck and tractor engines, arguing that agricultural demand for corn/ethanol will remain high and that long-haul trucks and farming equipment cannot practically transition to electric power.
 - *Note: Christopher Bilbury was listed to speak **00:33:02** but no transcript text was recorded for a separate statement.*
-

5. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Commissioners commended the Highway Department, Sheriff's Department, local towns, EMS, EMA (Tino and Kyle Johnson), City of Muncie, and MSD for excellent coordination and response during severe weather events on Thursday, Friday, and over the weekend **00:23:23**.
 - **Adjournment:** The meeting was officially recessed/adjourned to the next regular meeting on **February 22nd** by unanimous roll call vote **00:33:09**.
-